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Income Source & Income Change Indicator

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RAM-N – rCARI Team

Background

- Challenge with Expenditure data
  - Time consuming/effort
  - Data quality concerns
  - Difficult/absence of standard module for Remote Interviews
- Onset of Covid-19 & need for AFI data
    - WFP developed the income choice & income change indicator
    - Proxy for Economic vulnerability
      - Current coping capacity – CARI (rCARI)

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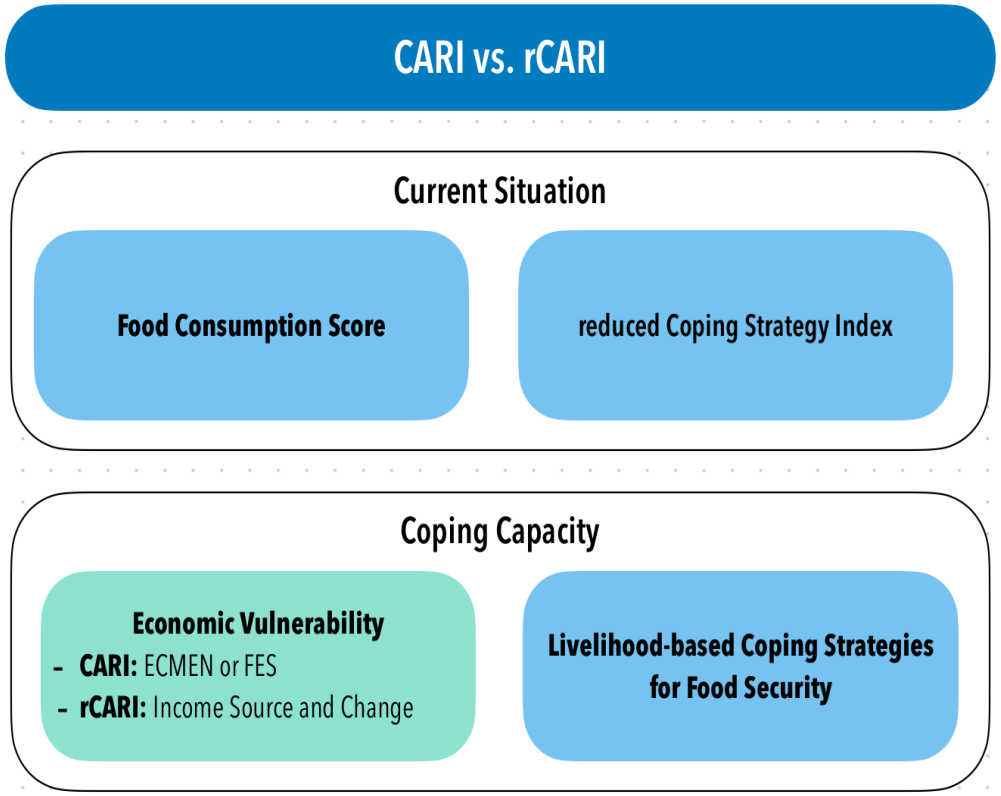
Background

- **CARI & rCARI (remote CARI) aggregate AFI indicators in a similar way**
  - **Differs in the Economic Vulnerability indicators**



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The income indicator

Variable	Questions in Income Module	Choice List
HHHOccupation	What is the occupation of the household head?	Open Ended
HHInc_PCT	How many household members are contributing to the household income?	Number
HHIncFirst	Main source of income for the household.](Hint: This is the most stable income source for the household)Relevance: HHIncNb > 0	1 Wage Labor – Professional 2 Wage Labor – Skilled 3 Wage Labor - Unskilled/Casual/Agriculture 4 Wage Labor - Unskilled/Casual/non-agriculture 5 Pension 6 Remittances 7 Aid/gifts 8 Borrowing money/Living off debt 9 High risk activity (e.g. begging, scavenging) 10 Saving/selling assets 11 Petty trade/selling on streets 12 Small trade (own business) 13 Medium/large trade (own business) 14 Small Agriculture production including livestock (own land/livestock) 15 Medium/large agriculture production including livestock (own land/livestock) 999 Other (specify)
HHIncFirst_Oth	SpecifyRelevance: HHIncFirst_SRi = '999'	
HHIncChg	Was there a change in income over the last year? (Please do not take into account the currency devaluation.)	0 No change 1 Increased 2 Reduced by less than 25% 3 Reduced by more than 25% and less than 50% 4 Reduced by more than 50%

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The income indicator

- Income Sources:
- Regular employment/income
  - Wage Labor – Professional/skilled
  - Pension
  - Small/Medium/large trade (own business)
  - Small/Medium/Large agriculture production including livestock (own or rented land/owned livestock)
- Irregular employment/income
  - Wage Labor - Unskilled/casual/agriculture/unskilled/casual/non-agriculture
  - Remittances
  - Petty trade/selling on streets
- No income
  - Aid/gifts
  - Borrowing money/Living off debt
  - High risk activity (e.g. begging, scavenging)
  - Saving/selling assets
  - No income source noted in *HHIncNb*

Income change is categorized as increased, reduced and no change.

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The income indicator

Indicator	Food Secure	Marginally Food Secure		Moderately Insecure	Severely Insecure
Main income source	Regular employment or income	Regular employment or income	Irregular employment or income	Irregular employment or income	No income
Income Change	Increased income and no change	Reduced income	Increased income and no change	Reduced income	

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The income vs. FES

F2F with long form FES					
Income Group	Inc<FES	Inc=FES	Inc>FES	Percentage of Sample	Percentage of Income Group with CARI_Inc < CARI_FES
Wage Labor - Professional	12	3	1	3.5%	75.0%
Wage Labor - Skilled	7	0	1	1.7%	87.5%
Wage Labor - Unskilled/Casual/Agriculture	28	4	10	9.1%	66.7%
Wage Labor - Unskilled/Casual/non-agriculture	8	2	3	2.8%	61.5%
Pension	1	0	0	0.2%	100.0%
Remittances	1	0	0	0.2%	100.0%
Aid/gifts	0	1	1	0.4%	0.0%
Petty trade/selling on streets	20	8	8	7.8%	55.6%
Small trade (own business)	13	2	0	3.2%	86.7%
Medium/large trade (own business)	2	0	0	0.4%	100.0%
Small Agriculture production including livestock	**158**	**19**	**5**	**39.4%**	**86.8%**
Medium/large agriculture production including livestock	**87**	**25**	**8**	**26.0%**	**72.5%**
Other (specify)	11	5	8	5.2%	45.8%
Total	348	69	45	100.0%	75.3%

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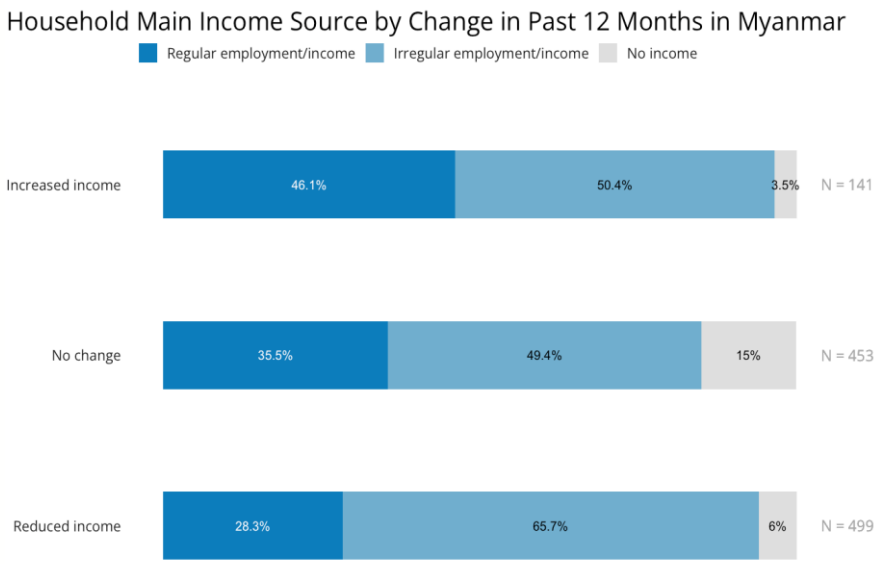
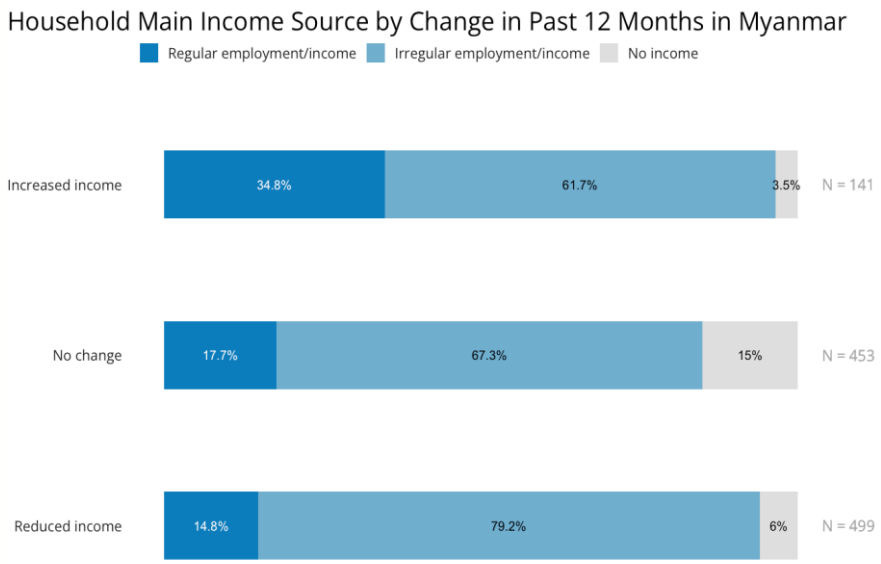
Before vs. After Recategorization - Myanmar

Before



Source: rCARI Validation Study, data collected June 2023

After



Source: rCARI Validation Study, data collected June 2023

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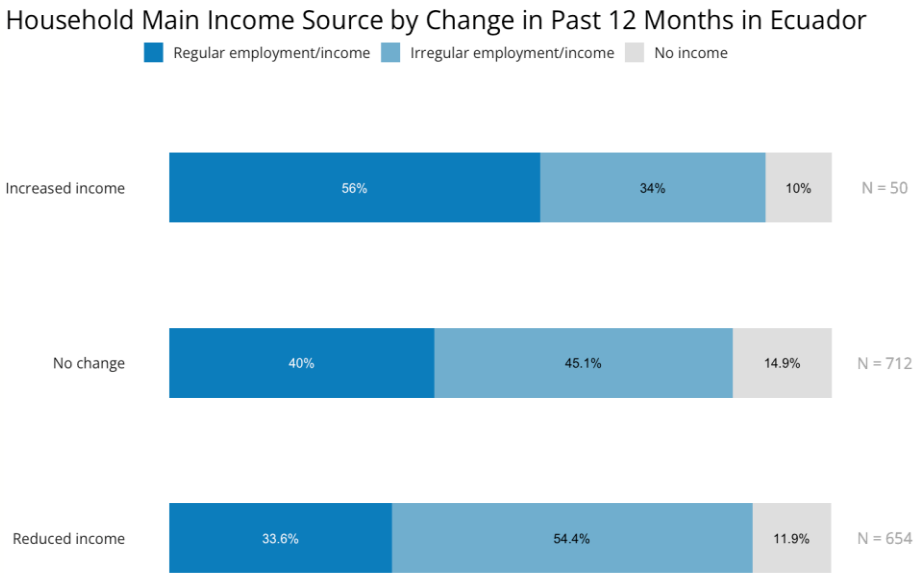
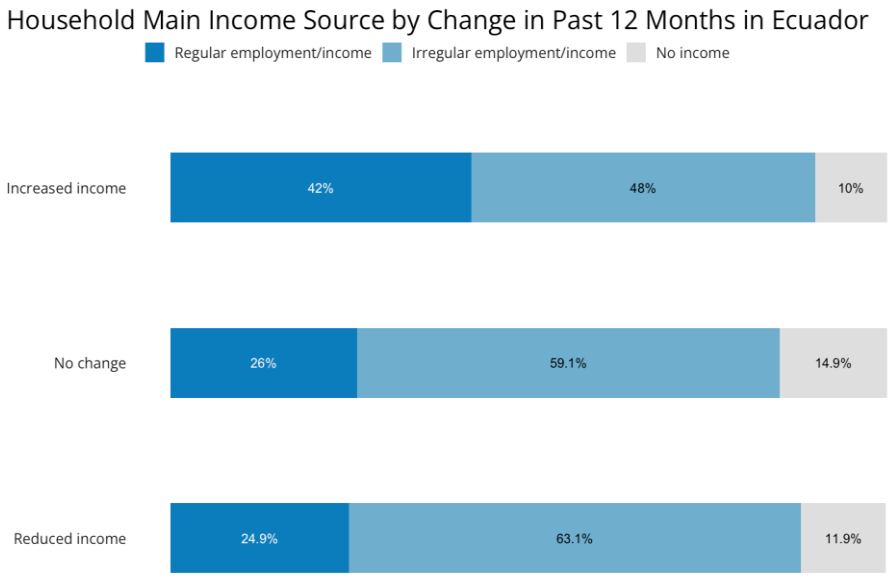
Before vs. After Recategorization - Ecuador

Before



Source: rCARI Validation Study, data collected August 2023

After



Source: rCARI Validation Study, data collected August 2023

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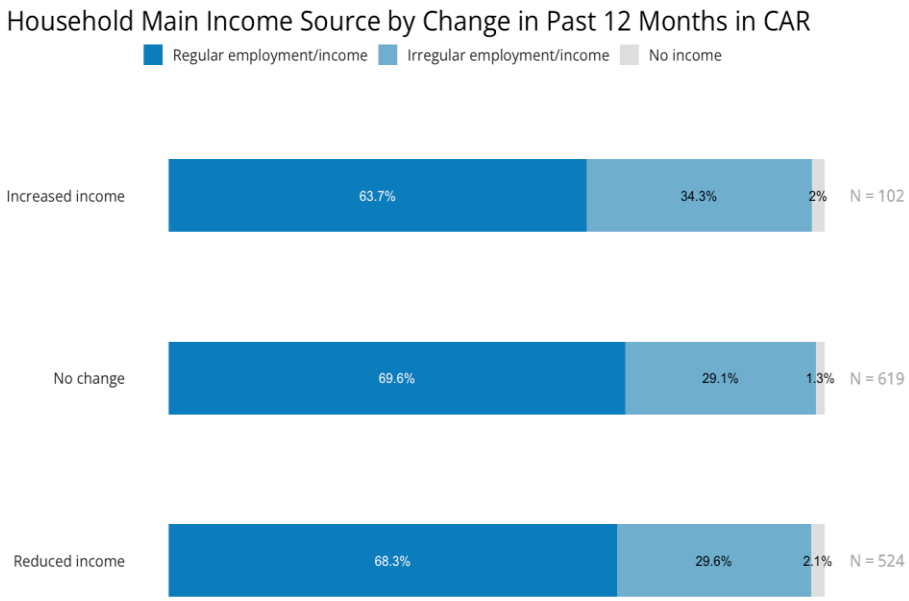
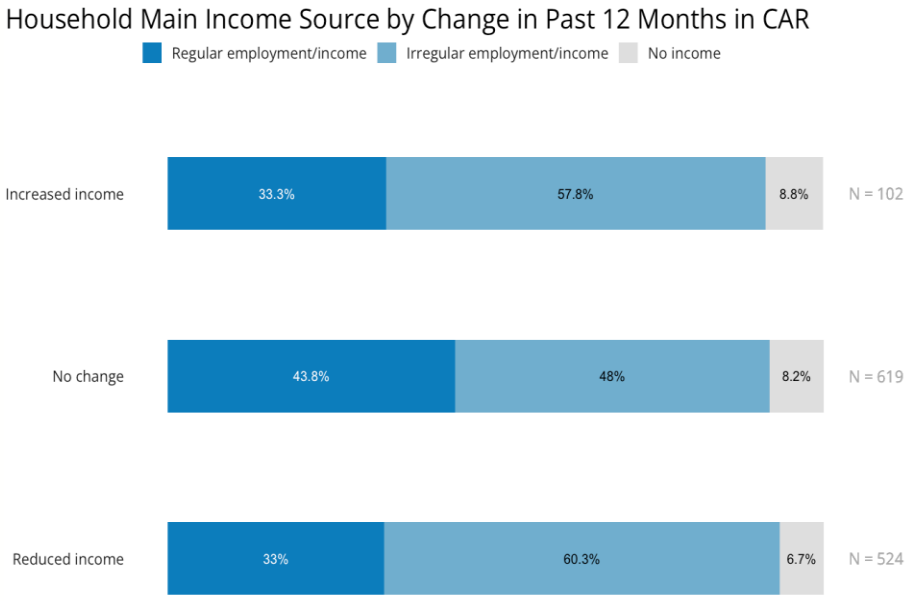
Before vs. After Recategorization - CAR

Before



Source: rCARI Validation Study, data collected September 2023

After



Source: rCARI Validation Study, data collected September 2023

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Next steps…

1. Expand the testing to additional available dataset
2. Possible reclassification of the income types based on the standardized income categorization
3. Sensitivity analysis of the individual income sources [HHIncFirst]
4. More data collection

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Questions/Comments…

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Updates on research components

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APP-FA – rCARI Study Team

The Technical Advisory Board

The Technical Advisory Board is made of 5 Professionals Across Academia, IPC, FSIN, BHA, and WFP

1. **Prof. Maxwell Daniel *(Tufts University, USA)***
2. **Prof. Sebastian Vollmer *(University of Gottingen, Germany)***
3. **Korpi Kaija *(IPC)***
4. **Federica Carfagna *(FSIN)***
5. **Michael Schenkmann (BHA)**
6. **Sidd Krishnaswamy *(WFP)***

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IPC vs CARI study

a. APP-FA started this component

1) Data preparation
2) Initial analysis and presentation
3) Data aggregation

b. Transferred to an independent consultant - Prof. Diego Rose (Tulane University, U.S.A)

1) Supported by the APP-FA Team

c. Initial analysis of complete

1) Results yet to be shared with the TAB
2) Qualitative interviews with stakeholders currently ongoing

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The rCARI validation & IPC/CARI compatibility studies

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APP-FA – rCARI Study Team

Objective

- **Primary:**

Validate the remote Consolidated Approach for Reporting Indicators of Food Insecurity (rCARI) – Using a survey experiment with stratified sample

- **Secondary**
    - **Validate income choice and income change indicator**
    - **Test and validate different expenditure modules (shorter versions)**

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Pilot Countries

- Global representation (In at least 4 RBx)
- Relevance of rCARI
- Mobile network penetration
  - West Africa [RBD] Burkina Faso & Central African Republic
  - Panama [RBP] Ecuador & Guatemala
  - Middle East [RBC] Iraq?? (Access is only limited to camps (refugees and IDPs))
  - Southeast Asia [RBB] Myanmar

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Study organogram…

APP-FA rCARI Team

- Designs the study methodology
- Provides technical support for COs
- Leads in field work (implementation)
- Data analysis and report writing

Head of VAM RBx

- Facilitates communication with COs & supporting training

Head VAM COs

- Supports in identifying the study areas together with the APP-FA team
- Budgeting and logistics
- Supports with admin work for training

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The survey experiment…

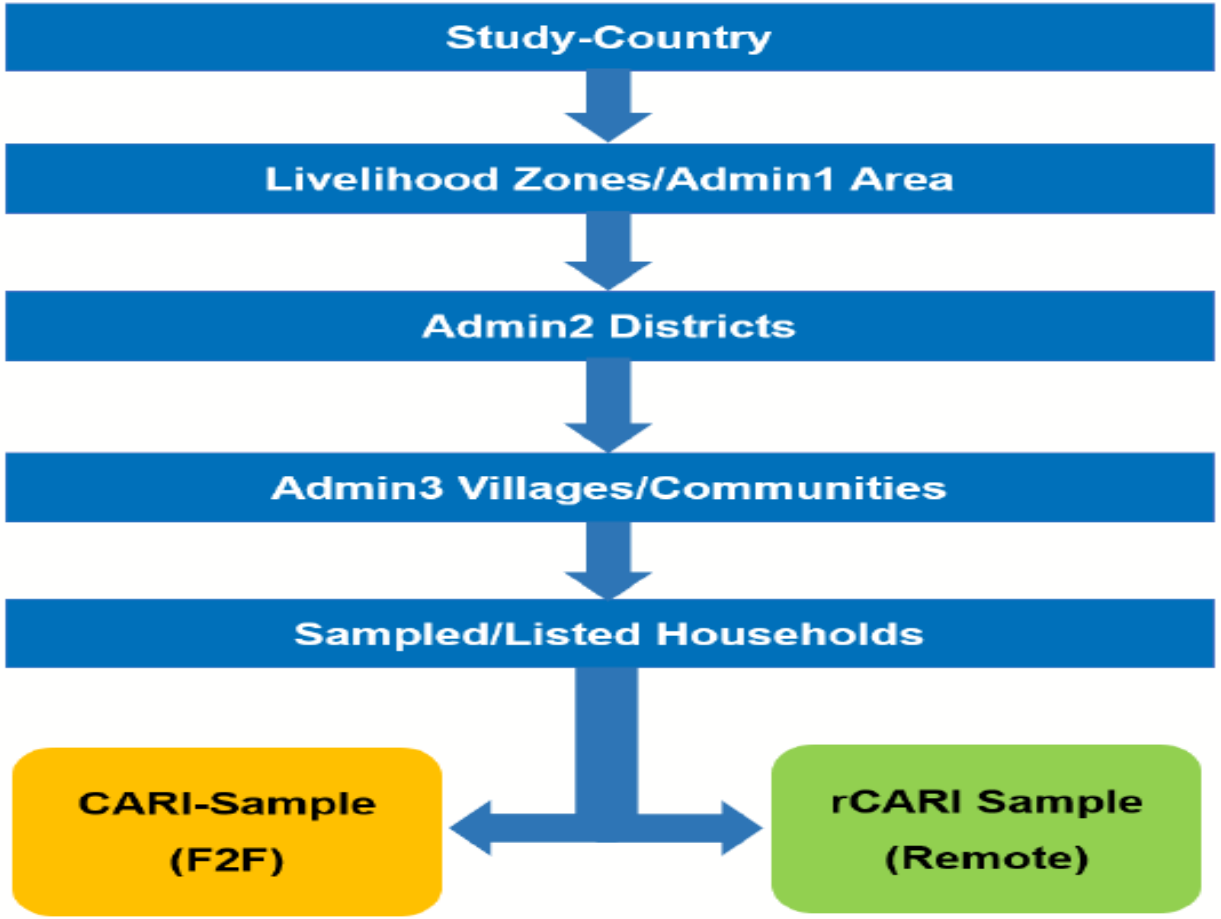

Figure 1: Sampling and Randomization Procedure

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Work done…

- Conducted two training of trainers' (ToT) workshops in for RBP & RBD
- 3 pilots completed so far
  - Myanmar
  - Ecuador
  - CAR –Two separate analysis produced
  - BKF – yet to be analysed
- 3 Reports produced and presented to BHA (Draft reports)

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Work completed and Workplan

Status / Activity	Completed	Completed	Completed	Completed	In-progress	In preparation phases
Pilot testing						
Myanmar						
Ecuador						
CAR						
Burkina Faso						
Iraq						
Guatemala						
Mauritania						
Data Analysis						On going
Report writing						On going

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Tentative work for remaining pilot

Time / Countries	Nov 2024	Dec 2024	Jan 2025	Feb 2025	Mar 2025	Apr 2025	May 2025	Jun 2025	Jul-Aug 2025
(1) Iraq	Planning	Data collection							
(2) Mauritania			Planning	Data Collection					
(3) Guatemala				Planning	Data Collection				
(4) Burkina Faso	Data Analysis Ongoing								
Data Analysis									
Report writing									

Note: There would be intermittent presentation to the TAB and BHA after each pilot country

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Questions/Comments…???

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